

The AI Code Review Checklist

6 Areas to Cover When AI Writes Most of the Code

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When AI writes 80% of the code, traditional code review misses what AI gets wrong. This checklist covers the six areas that matter most — each scored green, yellow, or red based on your team's current practice.

1 Correctness

- Verified against requirement AND unlisted edge cases
- Checked against prompt only
- Assumed correct because AI wrote it

Why it matters: AI code is correct for the stated case. The unstated cases are where it fails.

2 Dependencies

- Every import checked; versions pinned
- Imports checked; versions not pinned
- Libraries not verified (hallucinations possible)

Why it matters: 1 in 5 AI samples contains hallucinated library references.

3 Security

- Security checklist run; license audit done
- Obvious risks checked; no formal audit
- No security review for AI-authored sections

Why it matters: AI reproduces patterns from training data — including insecure ones.

4 Test Coverage

- Tests cover edge cases; reviewer inspected test logic
- Tests exist; content not independently verified
- AI wrote both code and tests; no independent check

Why it matters: AI tests assert AI's assumptions, not your requirements.

5 Architecture Fit

- Reviewed against architecture docs and patterns
- Checked for obvious conflicts only
- Architecture fit not reviewed; assumed correct

Why it matters: AI has your file, not your system. Context beyond the prompt is invisible.

6 Prompt Alignment

- Original requester validated against actual intent
- Reviewer confirmed against prompt text only
- Accepted as-is; intent not validated

Why it matters: AI optimizes for the words you wrote. The gap between those words and your intent is your bug.

SCORING GUIDE



6 Green:

Ship it. Your AI review process is solid.



4–5 Green, no Red:

Refine and ship. Fix yellows before scaling.



Any Red:

Stop. Fix before merging.



3+ Red:

Your team needs a process before shipping AI code.

The best time to run this is before the first AI-authored PR reviewed by someone who thinks it's the same as any other PR.